

Furniture E-Commerce Website — Design Brief

Build a full e-commerce and commercial website for a furniture retail business. The client sells a wide range of home furniture — chairs, tables, mirrors, sofas, cabinets, lighting, decor, and more — to both individual customers and possibly trade/bulk buyers. The site needs to let visitors easily browse, filter, and purchase products online.

1. Site Purpose & Audience

- E-commerce storefront where customers can browse the full catalog, view product details, and place orders online.
- Commercial/showcase site that reflects the brand's quality and style (this is a furniture shop, so visuals matter — clean, warm, upscale but approachable).
- Audience: local shoppers furnishing homes, possibly interior designers or bulk/business buyers.

2. Core Pages

- Home page: hero banner/slider, featured categories, bestsellers, new arrivals, promotions, brand story teaser, newsletter signup.
- Shop/Catalog page: full product grid with filters and sorting.
- Category pages: e.g. Chairs, Tables, Mirrors, Sofas, Storage, Lighting, Decor.
- Product detail page: multiple images/zoom, price, variants (size/color/material), stock status, description, dimensions, materials, care instructions, related products, customer reviews.
- Cart page.
- Checkout page (guest checkout + account checkout).
- User account area: order history, saved addresses, wishlist.
- About/Showroom page (address, hours, map if there's a physical store).
- Contact page (form, WhatsApp/phone, map).
- Blog or "Inspiration" page (optional, for style guides/room ideas — good for SEO).

3. Product Catalog & Filtering (key requirement)

Since the shop carries many different product types, filtering needs to be robust:

- Filter by category/subcategory (e.g. Living Room > Sofas, Bedroom > Mirrors).
- Filter by price range (slider).
- Filter by material (wood, metal, glass, fabric, rattan, etc.).
- Filter by color.
- Filter by size/dimensions.
- Filter by availability (in stock / pre-order).
- Sort by: price (low-high, high-low), newest, best-selling, top-rated.

- Search bar with autocomplete/product suggestions.
- Filters should be usable together (multi-select) and update results without a full page reload.

4. E-Commerce Functionality

- Shopping cart with quantity edit, save-for-later, and price totals.
- Secure checkout with shipping address, delivery date/time selection (furniture often needs scheduled delivery), and multiple payment options (card, cash on delivery, and any local payment gateway relevant to the region).
- Order confirmation emails and order tracking/status.
- Wishlist / "save for later."
- Product availability and stock management.
- Discount codes / promotions support.
- Shipping cost calculator based on location and/or item size (furniture shipping is often weight/size-based).

5. Design & UX

- Clean, modern, warm aesthetic that feels premium but not intimidating — furniture photography should be the star.
- Fully responsive (mobile, tablet, desktop) — most shoppers will browse on mobile first.
- Fast-loading image galleries (furniture sites are image-heavy, so optimize for performance).
- Easy navigation: sticky header, clear category menu, breadcrumbs on product pages.
- High-quality product photography placeholders (multiple angles, lifestyle shots, close-ups of materials).

6. Admin / Backend Needs

- Admin dashboard to add/edit/remove products, manage categories, update stock, view orders.
- Ability to upload multiple images per product and manage variants (e.g. same chair in different fabrics).
- Basic sales/analytics view (orders, revenue, top products).
- Manage discount codes and featured/homepage products.

7. Other Considerations

- Language: specify if the site needs to support more than one language (e.g. English + Arabic, with RTL support if Arabic is included).
- SEO basics: clean URLs, meta tags, alt text for images, sitemap.

- Integration needs: WhatsApp click-to-chat button (common for local furniture buyers to ask questions before ordering), Instagram/social feed on homepage.
- Trust elements: customer reviews, delivery/return policy page, warranty info if applicable.

Open Decisions Before Building

- Language(s) the site should support (RTL handling if Arabic is included).
- Payment methods available locally (which gateway/provider).
- Physical showroom or purely online (affects map/pickup/store-hours needs).